Decode the Skateboarder's Banner

The pennant flag on the skateboarder's pole is **not decoration**. Each column of squares is one character of a hidden message, written in **binary (8-bit ASCII)** — the same code your phone uses for every text you've ever sent.

□ white square = **1** ■ black square = **0** read each column **top** → **bottom**, columns **left** → **right**

Detective hints: Why might a whole row be black? • Find the columns with a *single* white square — those are **spaces**. Mark them first and you'll know the shape of the message before decoding a single letter. • The tiny **Mars rover** at the pennant's tip is a clue to the theme.

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25
row 1	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■
row 2	□	□	□	□	■	□	□	■	□	□	□	□	□	□	□	□	□	■	□	□	■	□	□	□	□
row 3	■	□	□	□	□	□	□	□	□	□	□	□	□	□	□	□	□	□	□	□	□	□	□	□	□
row 4	■	■	□	■	■	□	■	■	□	■	□	□	■	□	■	□	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	□	■
row 5	■	■	■	■	■	■	□	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	■	□	□	■	□	■	■	□
row 6	□	■	■	□	■	□	□	■	■	□	■	■	□	□	□	■	□	■	■	□	■	□	■	□	■
row 7	■	■	□	■	■	■	□	■	■	■	□	□	■	□	■	□	■	■	■	□	■	■	■	■	■
row 8	■	□	■	□	■	■	□	■	■	□	■	□	□	■	□	■	□	■	□	■	■	□	□	■	■

Write each decoded character in the box below its column. You'll need the **Decoder Card** to turn each column into a letter.

Mathemalchemy Docent Companion — decode-it-yourself activity for the *Silhouettes and Vortices* scene.